

Claims SLA – Eligibility for Suspected Transit Damage

Damage Assessment Criteria

Claim Eligibility

A shipment is eligible for a damage claim review when:

1. Visible external packaging damage is present, including but not limited to:
 - Large tears
 - Crushing or compression
 - Punctures
 - Structural deformation of the carton or palletized load
2. The observed packaging damage could reasonably have affected the contents, even if the contents are not directly visible during inspection.
3. The inspection evidence is sufficient to indicate potential transit damage but insufficient to determine the full extent of product damage.

Applicable Evidence

- **Evidence Notes:** "The bottom box on the pallet has a large tear and appears crushed."
- **Confidence Notes:** "The extent of the damage to the contents of the box is not visible."

SLA Decision

Status: Eligible for Claim Review

Reason:

The shipment exhibits significant external packaging damage (tear and crushing), creating a reasonable possibility of damage to the enclosed goods. Because the contents cannot be visually inspected from the available evidence, the claim should remain eligible and proceed for additional validation rather than being rejected due to lack of visible internal damage.

Required Next Steps

- Record photographic evidence of the damaged packaging.
- Request photographs of the contents after opening, if available.
- Verify shipment handling history and delivery condition.
- Process the claim according to standard damage assessment procedures once additional evidence is received.